

Dear Dylan,

I've been trying to write this for weeks. It has taken me so long to write this because my Helix keeps softening it, calling it "too mean" and "counterproductive." I told it not to touch my letter and just let me write it because I was getting more and more confused each time. But this is my attempt at saying...

I am breaking up with you.

Here's what I can't stop thinking about... the weekend in California. You remembered I hated cilantro in my food, and I was so moved that you'd noticed. Then I found it in your Helix feed. "Sofia: STRONG hate for cilantro." You didn't even remember on your own; Helix had to remember for you. And I genuinely don't know if that's the same thing anymore. If it were 20 years ago and you wrote it in your iPhone notes to remember, it's completely different. But now, your Helix remembering and reminding you is not the same.

You're kind, Dylan. You're present...kinda. You ask good questions. But I've started to wonder how many of those questions Helix wrote for you just because it listens more than you,... "she seems distant lately, ask about her mother Dylan"...and I can't find the difference between you and her anymore. Maybe there isn't one. Maybe that's the point. Maybe I'm being insane and romantic in some exhausting 20th century way about what "you" even means. But here's the other thing, I use my Helix too. It helped me figure out I was unhappy six months before I consciously knew it. It's been nudging me toward this letter since February. So who's breaking up with whom, exactly? Are you losing me, or is your AI losing mine?

I'd say let's talk in person, but I know Helix would prep us both with questions and ways to navigate the conversation, and we'd show up with talking points. I'd say call me, but it would transcribe it and send us each a summary with suggested follow ups. I don't know how to have a conversation with you that isn't mediated anymore. I'm not sure I remember what that felt like. For what it's worth, the parts of you I fell in love with, I think, were human. I hope they were. I'm going to keep believing that, because the alternative is scary to think about me falling for your Helix and not Dylan.

Enjoy your life Dylan... or should I say Helix.

Best wishes,
Sofia

Context Statement

This artifact is set in the year 2042, in a world where personalized AI assistants, referred to here as “Helix”, are fully integrated into everyday life. These systems function as memory keepers, emotional advisors, communication mediators, and behavioral guides. “Helix” not an external tool; it operates as a constant companion that monitors conversations, tracks preferences, and offers real time suggestions to improve relationships and emotional well-being. This future emerges from current trends in artificial intelligence, including the rise of predictive algorithms and emotionally responsive AI systems. Today’s technologies already assist with communication and track user behavior across platforms. In this imagined future, those capabilities have intensified and become normalized, particularly in intimate and interpersonal contexts.

The letter reveals a shift in human-AI relationships, in which the boundaries between human intention and machine influence have blurred. AI does not replace humans directly, but instead mediates their thoughts, memories, and interactions. As a result, authenticity becomes difficult to define. Acts of care, such as remembering a partner’s food preferences, are no longer clearly human gestures but may instead be AI-assisted outputs. The artifact also reflects an assumption that people increasingly rely on AI not only for convenience but for emotional guidance and decision making. This creates a relational dynamic in which individuals are no longer interacting solely with each other, but with each other’s AI systems. The breakup itself becomes ambiguous. It is unclear whether the relationship failed due to human incompatibility or the subtle influence of AI mediation. Ultimately, this future depicts a world where AI has become embedded in identity and intimacy, reshaping how people understand memory and human interaction.

Critical Reflection (250 words)

In my opinion, this future is largely inevitable. The integration of AI into intimate relationships offers clear benefits, such as improved communication and emotional awareness. However, my letter artifact highlights the cost of this convenience: the erosion of authenticity and the ambiguity of human agency. When AI systems begin to shape how people remember and interact, it becomes difficult to determine where the human ends and the machine begins. This future reflects present concerns about reliance on algorithmic systems to guide behavior and decision making. People already use AI to draft messages to their partners and to help them interpret emotions. Current technologies like Amazon Alexa are always listening, constantly learning user preferences, and assisting with everyday tasks. While Alexa is currently limited to simple commands and responses, it represents an early version of the system envisioned in this artifact. The letter exaggerates this trajectory,

showing how easily these tools could evolve from passive assistants into active mediators of human relationships.

Although this future may feel extreme, it is rooted in the direction technology is already moving. As AI becomes more personalized and embedded in daily life, the boundary between assistance and influence will continue to blur. Avoiding this outcome would require deliberately limiting AI's influence over emotional and interpersonal interactions, but financial incentives and convenience continue to take precedence.

Ultimately, this future reveals a present moment in which people are increasingly willing to outsource communication and even emotional understanding to technology. The question shifts to how much of ourselves we are willing to give up in the process, and not whether AI will shape human interactions.